PORTFOLIO 2026

Theresa Okodede

Product & *Business Strategy*

I help tech companies turn research into products and growth decisions.

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INTRODUCTION

I work best when the answer is not obvious yet.

I use research to understand the problem, commercial judgement to decide what the evidence means and structured execution to move it forward, across product, strategy and African market intelligence.

3

months from concept to internal pilot, against an 8 month plan

15

African markets screened for a cloud expansion decision

Q3

expansion decision, brought forward from the planned Q4

18

people led to a working MVP in three one-week sprints

WHAT I DO

Three ways I turn a question into a decision.

01

Product Strategy & Delivery

Turning ideas into products teams can build.

EVIDENCE

An investment platform taken from concept to internal pilot in 3 months earlier than plan.

02

Market Intelligence & Growth

Turning market data into a commercial view.

EVIDENCE

A 15 market African expansion study that brought the decision forward from Q4 to Q3.

03

Corporate Strategy & Execution

Turning ambition into measurable action.

EVIDENCE

A company wide dashboard tracking 100+ activities, each with an owner, reviewed every month.

CASE STUDY 01 · PRODUCT STRATEGY

Early stage investment platform

Turning an investment idea into a product engineers could build.

WHAT IT IS

A digital platform at that connects early stage founders with diaspora and local investors: a trusted place for startups to raise money and for investors to find and vet deals.

WHERE I CAME IN

I joined at the idea stage. There was a concept, but no product plan, no roadmap and no list of what to build first.

WHY IT WAS HARD

In investing, matching people is not enough. The product also had to handle trust, identity checks, compliance, investor protection and a clear review process, or no one would use it.

MY ROLE

Product Lead

I owned product direction from first concept to internal pilot: deciding what to build, in what order and making sure engineering team knew exactly what was needed and why.

Fintech · Startup investing

Concept to internal pilot

CASE STUDY 01 · HOW I BUILT IT

Rough idea to internal pilot in 3 months.

01 **Understand the problem**

Conducted market, competitor and research to validate the concept, along side investors and founder survey.

02 **Define and scope the MVP**

Defined the vision and requirements along with internal stakeholders, used RICE / MoSCoW to prioritise MVP features.

03 **Focus the pilot**

Used ecosystem research and market sizing across 6 Nigerian states to start the pilot in the strongest one.

04 **Build and test**

Managed the build in Jira and GitHub and ran usability tests to fix friction early.

3 months

to internal pilot, against an 8 month plan

26+

investors and founders researched to refine build

1 of 6

states chosen to focus the pilot

CASE STUDY 02 · MARKET ENTRY

Where should the company grow next?

15

countries screened

Compared on cloud, data rules, digital infrastructure readiness and market fit, then shortlisted the strongest.

→

3

deep studies

A full landscape and feasibility study for each, covering market size, PESTLE and competitive forces.

→

2

primary markets

Recommended to management as the priority markets for expansion.

> *Because the research finished early, the expansion decision was made in Q3 instead of the planned Q4 planned Q4*

CASE STUDY 03 · CORPORATE STRATEGY

The strategy behind a whole company.

Setting one clear, measurable direction across an enterprise technology business.

WHAT IT WAS

An IT services, setting its direction for the year across several business lines.

THE TASK

Understand the market, measure how the business was really performing, gather leadership views and turn it all into priorities the company could act on and measure.

MY ROLE AND RESULT

I contributed to major parts of the research and built the dashboard that now tracks 100+ company activities, each with an owner, timeline and status, reviewed every month.

HOW I APPROACHED IT

Outside in

Studied market size, competitors, pricing and economics for each service.

Inside out

Gathered business data, surveyed leaders and measured how the business was really performing.

Direction

Turned the findings into clear objectives, targets and owners.

CASE STUDY 04 · PRODUCT DELIVERY

SafeScan

A web app that tells you whether a product's ingredients are safe, in seconds.

WHAT IT DOES

Scan a product’s ingredient label, upload a photo or type it in and SafeScan returns a simple safety rating with simple description of the ingredients

I proposed the idea and it was chosen as our team's capstone product for the Women Techsters Fellowship 2025.

MY ROLE

Product Lead and Product Manager. I led a team of 18 across 7 specialist tracks, from research to a working product.

THE PROBLEM · 45 PEOPLE SURVEYED

80%

found ingredient names too technical

71.1%

could not tell what was safe or harmful

55.6%

had no time to research while shopping

86.7%

said they would use a simple safety tool

CASE STUDY 04 · HOW WE BUILT IT

Idea to working product in three sprints.

THREE WAYS TO CHECK A LABEL

Camera scan
Read a label live

Image upload
Use an existing photo

Manual input
Type it in

HOW IT WORKS

Reads the label → Cleans the text → Checks the database → Shows the result

Research shaped every choice: a web app to test the idea quickly, editable text so users can fix scanning mistakes and simple safety categories.

MVP FEATURES, PRIORITISED WITH MOSCOW AND RICE

- Accurate label reading
- Editable text
- Ingredient classification
- Clear safety results

18 team members led

7 specialist tracks

3 one-week sprints: foundation, integration, refinement

A working product people can use, built in three weeks.

SELECTED STRATEGIC WORK

Two shorter projects, both frameworks.

Enterprise AI & Automation Opportunity Programme

I contributed to a framework for finding where AI, automation or process improvement can help, before spending money on it: the method, scoring, governance and rollout plan.

WHAT IT PRODUCED

- A 5-stage operating model
- A 100-point scoring framework to rank ideas
- 4 delivery routes
- Clear ownership and governance

Helps the business decide what to automate, support with AI or redesign before committing engineers.

Cloud Partnership & Commercial Strategy Research

I benchmarked 4 competitor partner programmes, their incentives and rules, then drew out what they meant for how a cloud provider partners, prices and grows.

WHAT IT PRODUCED

- Global and regional partner programmes compared
- What stops African SMEs adopting cloud
- Free to paid conversion benchmarks
- Nigeria's data rules and public sector buying

Shaped partner tiers and entry criteri, and informed pricing and compliance decisions.

EXPERIENCE, CAPABILITIES AND EDUCATION

The track record behind the work.

Layer3

Research and Strategy Officer · Aug 2025 to present

Market entry research, corporate strategy and the company execution dashboard.

StarSector8

Market Research & Product Development · Feb 2026 to present

Product lead on an investment platform, from concept to internal pilot, plus Nigerian startup ecosystem research.

TrendX

Business Analyst · Jun 2024 to Jul 2025

Product requirements and market research in DeFi and asset tokenisation.

Product & Strategy

Discovery · MVP scoping · Requirements · Roadmapping · Prioritisation · OKRs

Research & Intelligence

Market sizing · Competitive and regulatory analysis · Market entry · Feasibility

Execution

Cross-functional coordination · Executive reporting · Dashboards

Tools & Methods

Jira · Trello · GitHub · Excel · Power BI · Odoo · Notion · Whimsical · MoSCoW · Kano · RICE · Lean Canvas · PESTLE · SWOT · Porter's Five Forces

MBA, Miva Open University (in progress)
BSc Agricultural Economics, University of Benin, 2023

LET'S GET TO WORK

Understand the problem. Make the trade-offs visible. *Build the structure to act.*

If you are facing a problem that is not fully defined yet, one that needs research, a clear decision and a way to execute, that is the work I want to do with you.

- Research & Market Intelligence
- Product Strategy & Development
- Business & Corporate Strategy
- Market Entry & Growth

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